The Lafayette Musicians

Direction Matthieu Du Motier

Lent baroque music in candlelight

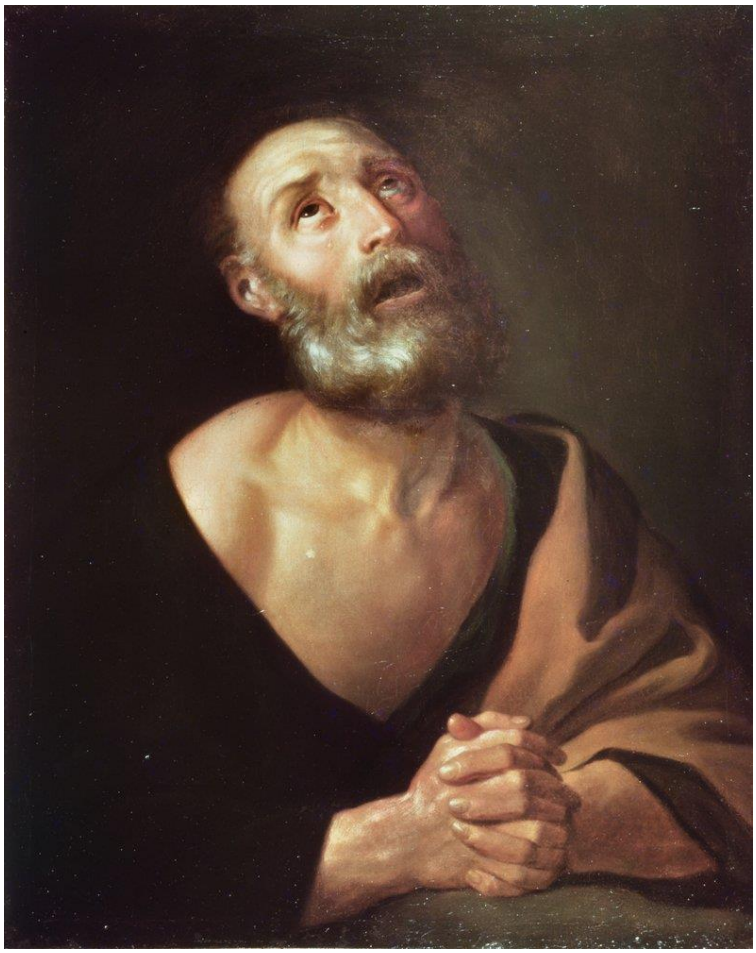
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Dallas Aldredge House Museum

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Lent Baroque music in candlelight

- *Gregorio ALLEGRI (1582-1652)*
  - *Miserere*
- *Marc-Antoine CHARPENTIER (1643-1704)*
  - *Transfige Dulcissime Jesu*
  - *Le Reniement de Saint Pierre*



The Composers

Gregorio Allegri (1582-1652) was an Italian composer and priest of the Baroque period, best known for his Miserere mei, Deus, an iconic vocal work. Born in Rome, Allegri began his musical career at a very young age. He was trained in music and quickly gained a reputation as a talented composer, particularly in the field of religious music.



He worked as a singer and composer at the Vatican's Sistine Chapel, where he wrote several liturgical works, including the famous Miserere (1630), which was performed at Good Friday services for centuries. This work, with its complex choral structure and distinctive harmonies, is one of the most emblematic compositions of Baroque music and was long kept secret in the Vatican.

Allegri also composed choral music and instrumental pieces, although his work focused primarily on sacred music. His career was marked by assignments in various churches and religious institutions, and he is considered one of the most important composers of his time.

Marc-Antoine Charpentier (1582-1652) is a major composer of French music in the 17th century. However, he suffered from the shadow cast on him by Lully, the omnipotent musician of the King of France Louis XIV. Charpentier was “only” a musician for Marie de Lorraine, Duchess of Guise, an important personality at the court of the King of France at Versailles, protector of the arts. He was also asked by Molière to write the music for certain famous pieces such as “The Imaginary Patient.” His grandiose style works wonders both in his works of sacred music and secular music. Charpentier composed a huge amount of sacred music, much more than other contemporary composers. His religious production, including motets, masses, oratorios and hymns, testifies to considerable artistic and spiritual involvement. Some music historians argue that the depth and richness of his religious works suggest true devotion. His long collaboration with the Jesuits, a particularly influential religious order at the time, could be an indicator of his religious sincerity. The Jesuits were known for their intellectual and spiritual rigor, and composing for them required a certain alignment with their values and mission. His sacred works do not seem purely formal or conventional, but often reveal an intense religious sensibility. In sum, although it is impossible to know with certainty Charpentier's inner motivations, the available evidence tends to show a man deeply influenced by the Catholic faith, whether or not he was driven by the demands of his time.



1. Gregorio Allegri - Miserere

The Miserere is a prayer of penance inspired by Psalm 51 traditionally sung in the services of Holy Week. This one was composed around 1638 for the Sistine Chapel on the text of Psalm 50, by Gregorio Allegri, musician to Pope Urban VIII.

This work, designed for nine a cappella voices, divided into two choirs of 5 and 4 voices, was intended for the exclusive use of the Sistine Chapel and was not published outside. However, in 1770, the young Mozart, aged 14, achieved the feat of transcribing it from memory after simply hearing it on Good Wednesdays and Fridays. Admiring this feat, Pope Clement XIV, far from blaming Mozart, awarded him the Order of the Golden Spur a few days later.

Translations

Miserere mei, Deus, secundum magnam misericordiam tuam; et secundum multitudinem miserationum tuarum, dele iniquitatem meam.	*Have mercy on me, O God, according to your great mercy; and according to the multitude of your tender mercies, blot out my iniquity.*	Aie pitié de moi, ô Dieu, selon ta grande miséricorde; et selon l'abondance de tes compassions, efface mon iniquité.
Amplius lava me ab iniquitate mea, et a peccato meo munda me.	*Wash me yet more from my iniquity, and cleanse me from my sin.*	Lave-moi encore plus de mon iniquité, et purifie-moi de mon péché.
Quoniam iniquitatem meam ego cognosco, et peccatum meum contra me est semper.	*For I know my iniquity, and my sin is always before me.*	Car je reconnais mon iniquité, et mon péché est toujours devant moi.
Tibi soli peccavi, et malum coram te feci: ut justificeris in sermonibus tuis, et vincas cum judicaris.	*Against you alone have I sinned, and I have done evil before you: that you may be justified in your words and may overcome when you are judged.*	Contre toi seul j'ai péché, et j'ai fait le mal devant toi : ainsi tu seras juste dans tes paroles et tu triompheras dans ton jugement.
Ecce enim in iniquitatibus conceptus sum, et in peccatis concepit me mater mea. Ecce enim veritatem dilexisti:	*For behold, I was conceived in iniquities, and in sins my mother conceived me.*	Voici, j'ai été conçu dans l'iniquité, et ma mère m'a conçu dans le péché.
incerta et occulta sapientiae tuae manifestasti mihi.	*For behold, you have loved truth: the uncertain and hidden things of your wisdom you have made manifest to me.*	Voici, tu as aimé la vérité : les choses incertaines et cachées de ta sagesse, tu me les as révélées.

Asperges me hysopo, et mundabor:

lavabis me, et super nivem dealbabor.

Auditui meo dabis gaudium et laetitiam: et exsultabunt ossa humiliata.

Averte faciem tuam a peccatis meis: et omnes iniquitates meas dele.

Cor mundum crea in me, Deus : et spiritum rectum innova in visceribus meis.

You'll sprinkle me with hyssop, and I'll be cleansed: you shall wash me, and I shall be made whiter than snow.

You'll make me hear joy and gladness: and my humiliated bones shall rejoice.

Turn away your face from my sins: and blot out all my iniquities.

Create in me a clean heart, O God: and renew a right spirit within me.

Tu me purifieras avec l'hysope, et je serai purifié :

Tu me laveras, et je serai plus blanc que la neige.

Tu me feras entendre la joie et l'allégresse : et mes os humiliés exulteront.

Détourne ta face de mes péchés : et efface toutes mes iniquités.

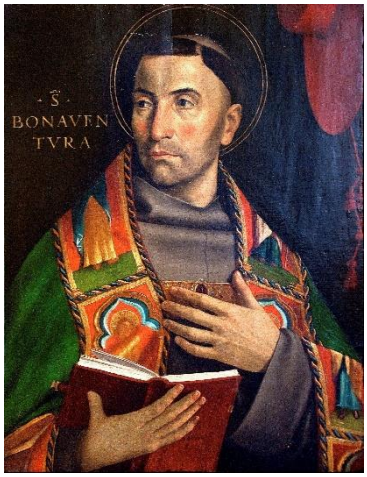
Crée en moi un cœur pur, ô Dieu : et renouvelle un esprit droit en mon sein.



The Repentance of Saint Peter - *Johannes Moreelse*

2. Marc-Antoine Charpentier : *Transfige Dulcissime Jesu*

This motet* for choir and orchestra was intended to be sung during mass before communion, at the moment when the priest raises the host. The work, in two parts, which was composed for Marie de Lorraine, has the character of a prayer, and brings the listener to contemplation. It is a magnificent demonstration of fugue and counterpoint (Exposure of a musical theme by one performer, which is then taken up by the other musicians, one after the other. The themes overlapping and resonating in an almost "magical" harmonious way!) and a splendid example of baroque music. The text was written by Saint Bonaventure (1217-1274), a 13th century Franciscan theologian. It is part of the prayers of devotion to the Passion of Christ, expressing a deep desire for communion with the suffering and love of Christ.



**a motet is a polyphonic musical composition of a religious nature, generally sung a cappella or accompanied by an instrumental ensemble. It is a vocal genre that appeared in the middle Ages and evolved through the Renaissance and the Baroque period*

Translations

Transfige, dulcissime Domine Jesu, medullas et viscera animæ meæ, suavissimo ac saluberrimo amoris tui vulnere, vera serenaque et Apostolica sanctissima charitate, ut langueat et liquefiat anima mea solo semper amore, et desiderio tui te concupiscat, et deficiat in atria tua, cupiat dissolvi, et esse tecum. Da ut anima mea te [semper] esuriat, panem Angelorum, refectionem animarum sanctarum, panem nostrum quotidiaanum supersubstantialem, habentem omnem dulcedinem et saporem, et omne delectamentum suavitatis, te, in quem

Pierce, my sweet Lord Jesus, the marrow and entrails of my soul with a very sweet and very salutary touch of your love, and with a true apostolic and most holy charity, so that it always languishes and liquefies in this one and divine love, and in the desire of you alone, that it desires you and is spent in the thought of your tabernacles, and that she wishes to be released from her body to be and remain with you. Make my soul [always]sweetness and flavor, and all pleasure of sweetness. May my heart, O good Jesus, always hunger for you, and eat you, my God, whom the Angels desire to hungry for you, oh sacred bread

Transpercez, mon doux Seigneur Jésus, les moelles et entrailles de mon âme par une très-douce et très-salutaire plaie de votre amour, et par une vraie apostolique et très Sainte charité, afin qu'elle languisse et se liquéfie toujours en ce seul et divin amour, et au désir de vous seul, qu'elle vous désire et se pâme en la pensée de vos tabernacles, et qu'elle souhaite d'être déliée de son corps pour être et demeurer avec vous. Faites que mon âme ait [toujours] faim de vous, ô sacré pain des Anges, qui êtes la réfection et nourriture des âmes saintes, notre pain quotidien et substantiel, qui a toute douceur et

desiderant Angeli prospicere, semper esuriat et comedat cor meum, et dulcedine saporis tui repleantur viscera animæ meæ, te semper sitiat fontem vitæ, fontem sapientiæ et scientiæ fontem æterni luminis, torrentem voluptatis, ubertatem domus Dei, te semper ambiat, te quærat, te inveniat, ad te tendat, ad te perveniat, te meditetur, te loquatur et omnia operetur in laudem et gloriam nominis tui, cum humilitate et discretione , cum dilectione et delectatione, cum facilitate et affectu , cum perseverantia usque in finem :

Et tu sis solus semper spes mea, tota fiducia mea, divitiæ meæ, delectatio mea, jucunditas mea, gaudium meum, quies et tranquillitas mea, pax mea, suavitas mea, odor meus, dulcedo mea, cibus meus, refectio mea, refugium meum, auxilium meum, portio mea, possessio mea, thesaurus meus, in quo fixa, et firma, et immobiliter semper sit sapientia mea, radicata mens mea, et cor meum.

Amen

of the Angels, who are the refection and food of holy souls, our daily and super substantial bread, which has all look upon; and may the bowels of my soul be filled with the sweetness of your flavor. May my mind always be changed by you, O fountain of life, fountain of wisdom and knowledge, fountain of eternal light, torrent of pleasure, abundance of the house of God.
May he always desire you, seek you, find you, aspire to you, reach you, meditate on you, speak to you, and do and operate all things in the praise and glory of your name, with humility and discretion, with love and pleasure, with ease and affection, and with perseverance until the end.
May you always, O my God, be my hope, all my confidence, my riches, my joy, my pleasure, my joy, my rest and my tranquility, my peace, my sweetness, my odor, my sweetness, my meat, my refection, my refuge, my help, my wisdom, my portion, my possession and my treasure, to which my spirit and my heart be always fixedly attached and firmly rooted.

Amen

saveur, et tout plaisir de suavité. Que mon cœur, ô bon Jésus, ait toujours faim de vous, et vous mange, vous mon Dieu, que les Anges désirent regarder ; et que les entrailles de mon âme soient remplies de la douceur de votre saveur. Que toujours mon esprit soit altéré de vous, ô fontaine de vie, fontaine de sagesse et de science, fontaine de lumière éternelle, torrent de voluptés, abondance de la maison de Dieu.
Que toujours il vous désire, vous cherche, vous trouve, aspire à vous, parvienne à vous, vous médite, vous parle, et fasse et opère toute chose en la louange et gloire de votre nom, avec humilité et discrétion, avec amour et plaisir, avec facilité et affection, et avec persévérance jusqu'à la fin. Que toujours, ô Mon Dieu, vous soyez Mon espérance, toute ma confiance, mes richesses, ma liesse, mon plaisir, ma joie, mon repos et ma tranquillité, ma paix, ma suavité, mon odeur, ma douceur, ma viande, ma réfection, mon refuge, mon aide, ma sagesse, ma portion, ma possession et mon trésor, auquel mon esprit et mon cœur soient toujours fixement attachés et fermement enracinés.

Amen

3. Marc-Antoine Charpentier : *Le Reniement de Saint-Pierre*

In his ***Denial of Saint-Pierre***, Charpentier sets to music the episodes of the Passion of Jesus following the end of the last meal including: Christ and his disciples at the Mount of Olives, the kiss and betrayal by Judas, Peter cutting off the ear of Malchus, who came to arrest Christ, the crowd carrying Jesus away, Peter, considered the most faithful disciple, denying he knows Christ three times, the rooster crowing, and finally, Peter, inconsolable, pouring out his words in rivers of tears.

This magnificent work was composed for Marie de Lorraine for the celebration of Easter ceremonies. It contains poignant pages of high intensity. The final lament reaches expressive heights.

Translations

Cum cænasset Jesus et dedisset discipulis suis corpus suum ad manducandum et sanguinem suum ad bibendum, exierunt simul in montem Oliveti. Tunc dixit illis Jesus: "Omnes vos scandalum patiemini in me, in hac nocte. Scriptum est enim: percutiam pastorem, et dispergentur oves gregis." Respondens autem Petrus, ait illi: "Et si omnes scandalizati fuerint in te, nunquam ego scandalizabor."
"Amen dico tibi, Petre, quia in hac nocte, antequam gallus cantet, ter me negabis." "Ah! Domine! Etiam si oportuerit me mori tecum, non te negabo."

When Jesus had dined and he had given them his body to eat and his blood to drink, they went out together to the mount of Olives. Jesus said to them: "You will all be offended for my sake, this night. For it is written: I will smite the shepherd and the sheep of the flock shall be scattered."
But Peter, replying, said to him: "Though all men shall be offended because of thee, yet will I never be offended."
"Verily I say unto thee, Peter, that this night, before the cock crows, thou shalt deny me thrice."
"Ah! Lord! Though I should die with thee, yet will I not deny thee."

Jésus dîna et donna à ses disciples son corps à manger et son sang à boire, puis ils allèrent au mont des Oliviers.
Alors Jésus leur dit : Tous vous souffrirez du scandale à cause de moi cette nuit. Car il est écrit : Je frapperai le pasteur, et les brebis seront dispersées du troupeau.
En réponse Pierre lui dit : même si tous se scandalisent à cause de toi, jamais moi je ne me scandaliserai.
- Amen, je te dis, Pierre, que cette nuit, avant que le coq chante, trois fois tu me renieras.
- Ah Seigneur ! Même si cela devait me mener à mourir avec toi, je ne te renierais pas.

Similiter et omnes discipulis dixerunt: "Non te negabimus."
Ecce Judas unus de duodecim venit, et cum eo turba multa cum gladiis et fustibus irruerunt in Jesum, et tenuerunt, quod videntes discipuli ejus fugerunt. Et Petrus extendens manum, exemit gladium suum et percutiens servum pontificis auriculam ejus amputavit. Cui dixit Jesus:

"Converte, Petre, gladium tuum in locum suum: calicem quem dedit mihi Pater, non vis ut bibam illum?"
Ministri ergo Judæorum comprehenderunt et ligaverunt Jesum, et cum duceretur ad principium sacerdotum sequebatur eum Petrus a longe usque in atrium pontificis. Quem cum vidisset ostiaria dixit ei: "Numquid et tu ex discipulis hominis istus es?"
"O mulier! Non sum. Non novi hominem."
Et introductus est Petrus in domum. Cum sederet ad ignem cum servis et ministris, ut calefaceret se, alia serva ait illi: "Et tu cum Jesu Nazareno eras?"

"O mulier, non eram, non novu hominem."

Likewise all the disciples said "We will not deny thee."
Lo, Judas, one of the twelve, came, and with him a great multitude with swords and staves ran up to Jesus and held him, and seeing this, the disciples fled.
And Peter stretched out his hand and drew his sword and struck a servant of the high priest and cut off his ear. Jesus said to him:

"Peter, put away your sword. Do you not wish me to drink the cup that my Father has given me?"

Therefore the soldiers of the Jews took Jesus and bound him and led him to the chief priests. Peter followed at a distance, even to the house of the bishop. A doorkeeper saw him and said to him: "Are you not also a disciple of that man?"

"O woman! I am not. I do not know the man."
And Peter enered the house. As he sat by the fire with the servants and soldiers to warm himself, another servant said to him: "Were you also with Jesus of Nazareth?"

"O woman, I was not! I do not know the man."

Les autres disciples dirent de même. Voici que Judas, l'un des douze, vint là, avec une foule nombreuse avec des épées et des bâtons, et ils se jetèrent sur Jésus et s'en emparèrent.

Voyant cela ses disciples s'enfuirent. Et Pierre, étendant la main, sortit son glaive, et, frappant un serviteur du grand prêtre, lui coupa l'oreille. Sur quoi Jésus dit :

« Remets, Pierre, ton épée à sa place. Le calice que mon Père m'a donné, tu voudrais que je ne le boive pas ? »

Les chefs des Juifs appréhendèrent Jésus et le lièrent, et comme il était conduit chez le grand prêtre, Pierre suivait de loin, jusque dans l'atrium. Le voyant, la portière lui dit : N'étais-tu pas un des disciples de cet homme ? - O femme, ce n'est pas moi, je ne connais pas cet homme.
Et Pierre fut conduit dans la demeure, et s'assit devant le feu avec le personnel pour se chauffer, quand une autre servante lui dit : « et toi, tu étais avec Jésus de Nazareth ?

- O femme, je n'y étais pas, je ne connais pas cet homme.

Tunc interrogavit eum cognatus ejus cujus abscidit auriculam, dicens:

(Cognatus Malchi): "Nonne te vidi in horto cum eo? Nonne tu percussisti Malchum? Vere tu eras."

(Ostiaria, Ancilla): "Nonne tu Galileus es? Vere tu es."

"Nam et loquela tua manifestum te facit. Tu es discipulis hominis istus."

(Petrus): "Non sum. Vere non eram. Nescio quid dicitis."

Et continuo gallus cantavit. Tunc respexit Jesus Petrum et recordatus est Petrus verbi Jesu, et egressus foras, flevit amare.

Then a relation of the one whose ear he had cut off questioned him:

(Relation of Malchus): "Did I not see you in the garden with him? Did you not cut off Malchus' ear? Surely it was you."

(Ostiaria,Ancilla): "Aren't you a Galilean? Surely you are." "Even your accent gives you away. You are a disciple of that man."

(Peter): "I am not. Surely I was not. I don't know what you are talking about."

And immediately the cock crew. Then Jesus looked at Peter, and Peter remembered the words of Jesus, and he went out, and wept bitterly.

Alors un parent de celui à qui il avait coupé l'oreille (Malchus) l'interrogea :

Ne t'ai-je pas vu dans le jardin ?
- Je n'en suis pas ...
- N'est-ce pas toi qui a frappé l'oreille de Malchus ?
- Vraiment je n'y étais pas.
(Ostiaria, Ancilla)
N'es-tu pas de Galilée ? Tu l'es, tu y étais.
- Je ne sais pas ce que tu veux dire. - Ton aspect le manifeste bien, tu es un disciple de cet homme.
- Je ne le suis pas, je ne le fus ni n'en étais. Je ne sais pas ce que tu veux dire, je ne connais pas cet homme.

Aussitôt le coq se mit à chanter. Alors Jésus regarda Pierre. Pierre se souvint des mots de Jésus et, sortant dehors, pleura amèrement.



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We hope this music touched your heart and helps you to peacefully and prayerfully journey through Lent and experience the joy of Easter !

May God bless and protect you and your beloved ones !